Beelzebub is Weeping

By Robert Haag

INTRODUCTION

This is the story of how I came to dwell in the region of space and time known as Hell; did that rhyme? Oh well, it doesn't matter. My name is... or more specifically was- William Michael Smith Jr. People tended to call me Billy as not to confuse me with my father- him being William Michael Smith Sr. in case you hadn't guessed. Anyway, as I said I'm in Hell. Oh don't worry; I'm not selling or buying anything, I just wanted to tell you how I got here. I figured it would help pass the time (of course time is fairly irrelevant in Eternity, but do me a favor and humor me).
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Just to allay another fear you may be having: No, I'm not going to be one of those lost souls who claim that they don't belong Here. Very few people are more deserving of this fate than I am. The list of things I did to get here is as long as your arm. If I went into the details I'm sure that I'd probably lose your interest and that's not why I'm here.

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This is the story of the very first atrocity that I'd ever committed. I was twelve years old and it involved the one and only Santa Claus...

It was about a week before Christmas, my aunt and uncle were staying with us for the Holidays and had brought my cousins with them.

Katie was eleven, I can still remember when I was about six and she and I did the old "you show me yours and I'll show you mine" game, afterwards she went running through the house informing the family about the intimate details of my genitals. She wasn't allowed to come back for about a year.

Jim was nine, he was okay, except that he had this habit of humming the theme song to "The A-Team," after about an hour just about anyone would be driven to do bodily harm to the kid. Heck, one time dad had to restrain grandma when she tried to push him down a flight of stairs.

On my side of the family there was my older brother Joey, I think he was a little jealous about me being named after dad and not him. I guess he figured

that since he was the first born he should be the "Junior" of the family.

Anyway, he was sixteen and felt that since he was the only teenager of the group that he was too important for the rest of us. He spent most of his time sitting in a corner listening to his headphones.

The youngest member of the family was five year old Ricky. Out of all of us, he was the only one who still believed in Santa Claus. The rest of us just considered him to be some myth made up by business executives as an excuse to sell toys to the mass markets.

Strangely enough it turned out that Ricky was right. Santa did exist; unfortunately for Santa, I existed too.

It was 11:30 or so on Christmas Eve when it all started. Katie and I were up watching television in the front room when we heard a loud noise that seemed to be coming from the roof.

"Strange," said Katie. "It almost sounds like the hooves of twelve tiny reindeer pulling along a toy-laden sled."

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I looked at her for a moment and then said, *"Oh, shut the hell up!* It's probably just a burglar or ax murderer or something."

"Cool!" She said, "do you think we should wake up our parents?"

"Nah, they'll just think that we're making it up. Let's go get Joey."

Now, Joey never liked people coming into his room; he said that it was an invasion of his privacy. Of course that never stopped me.

We ran up to Joey's room and barged in, it was apparent that he was in the midst of a, let us say, *enjoyable* dream. We could tell by the pup tent in his sheets. Not to go into the gory details but suffice it to say that he wasn't too thrilled with being woken up.

It took us a couple of minutes to convince him that we weren't making the story up, and he agreed to go down with us to check the noises out.

On our way downstairs both Ricky and Jim came out of their room to see what was going on. After we told them Ricky said, "Oh boy! Santa Claus!"

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None of us were in the mood to contradict him. When we got down to the fireplace we could here the noise of someone trying to climb down the damn thing.

"I bet it's a crook," said Joey, "He's trying to make us think he's Santa Claus."

"Let's teach him a lesson," said Katie. "We need to show this bastard what happens to people who attempt to degrade cherished childhood icons!"

"Oh, shut the hell up!" I said.

We quickly spread out and hid behind furniture. Within a couple of moments we caught our first glimpse of our intruder.

This guy was good. He was decked out in the whole traditional Santa garb: red coat, white trim, beard, the whole nine yards.

Once he was completely out of the chimney he proceeded to look around as if casing the joint; from the looks of the bag he was carrying it was apparent that he'd hit a few other places along the way.

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The phony Santa's eyes came to rest on the Christmas tree, he smiled and nodded and the made his way towards the presents.

He didn't get two steps before Katie whacked him in the back of the legs with the fireplace poker.

"Holy Shit!" he yelled as he went crashing to the floor.

"Get Him!" I yelled. Within mere moments everyone was out from behind their hiding places kicking, punching, and biting the guy. Well everyone, that is, but Ricky.

"Stop! Don't hurt him, He's just here to give us presents!!!" Ricky yelled.

"Oh get off it Ricky, this isn't really Santa Claus! Santa Claus doesn't really exist!!" I yelled.

"Yes I do!" screamed the fat guy.

"Oh shut the hell up!" I said and then kicked him in the teeth.

"If you are Santa, then what's my name?" asked Jim.

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"Uh, well...you see I don't know every child by name anymore. I used to, but with the recent population explosion of the last century it's just downright impossible to keep track." He said.

"You mean you don't know my name?" asked Ricky in a cracking voice that I recognized as his "I'm about to burst out crying" voice.

"Uh, well, you see...I...uh..." the Santa wannabe stammered.

"Oh shut the hell up!" screamed Ricky as he kicked the old fart in the teeth.

He then looked at me and said, "Katie was right. let's teach this son-of-a-bitch a lesson!"

I was so proud, I thought that I was going to cry. I won't bore you with the unsettling details, but over a three hour period we taped his mouth shut, stripped him naked, bound his arms and legs, and then proceeded to go to work.

Ricky took to whapping the fat man's genitalia with the fireplace poker, the whole time muttering under his breath.

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Katie and I were enjoying ourselves by pulling out "Santa's" toe nails with a pair of pliers that was freshly liberated from under the tree: my gift to Dad.

Jim was sticking small pieces of wood underneath the old man's fingernails.

Joey just sat back and taped the whole thing with a video camera that he'd found in the bag the guy was carrying.

Oddly enough, during the whole torture process neither my parents, or Katie's, were awoken my the moans of intense pain that our victim was making. Heavy sleepers I guess.

Well, after a while the novelty of the whole thing began to wear off and we weren't exactly sure what to do with him. Ricky suggested several times over that we burn him alive (never mess with a kids beliefs).

Luckily we didn't have to make any decisions, because at that time an elf came scurrying down the chimney. At first we thought that it was one of the fat guy's accomplices, but on close examination we were

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convinced that the pointed ears he was sporting were, in fact, real.

I must say that we were all a little embarrassed about the situation, but the elf quickly put our concerns to rest.

"This happens about once a year, it started in the 1960's. We keep telling the big guy that it's time to retire, but he keeps on trying. This might be the last straw for him. You kid's worked him over real good," he said with an evil little smile.

It took a while, but Santa was airlifted out on a special medical sled. He kept referring to us as "those little bastards." The elves told us that that was what he usually called them.

Anyway, once they were gone we all went off to bed. When we woke up later on in the morning our parents were confused about the way we were acting.

"If you guys don't shape up, there's a chance that Santa might pass you kids over next Christmas," said my dad.

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"Oh, I got a feeling he'll be doing that anyway," said Ricky with a smile.

Well, that's my story. I know that doesn't completely explain what I'm doing down Here, but it's a start. I might get to the rest at some later date.

I'm afraid that I have to go now, it's my turn to give Satan his foot massage.

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NFL CAUTIONARY NOTE

- ***Vision? Nary! Magazine published by VN Productions was originally both a 24 page hard-copy printed magazine and an e-zine.***
- ***It was printed in hard-copy form quarterly and the e-zine updated after each hard-copy magazine was distributed.***
- ***The editor of the magazine is David Raffin, and subscriptions were sold for $8.00 for 4 issues.***
- ***It does appear that VN Productions was the personal business of Mr. Raffin and no ASIN or ISBN number was issued for this publication.***
- ***At some point, Mr. Raffin decided to stop printing the hard copy version of this magazine and convert to a completely digital distribution format.***
- ***To obtain a copy of this issue in it's hard-copy form, contact David Raffin at david@vision-nary.com – The charge for this issue is $2.00 and must be paid via PayPal.***

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